AURANGZEB: RELIGIOUS POLICY, NORTH INDIA & THE RAJPUTS - ASCII MASTER FLOW
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STARTING QUESTION
  How far did sharper hierarchy, uneven coercive practice and Rajput
  mismanagement weaken Mughal legitimacy in North India?

1) TOPIC BOUNDARY
  Topic 21 -> succession war only as bridge to 1658.
  Topic 22 -> law, jizyah, temple evidence, Jat/Satnami/Sikh context, Rajput rupture.
  Topic 23 -> Shivaji, Marathas, Deccan war, jagirdari crisis.

2) CHRONOLOGY ANCHORS
  1658 accession result
   -> 1667 Jai Singh dies
   -> c.1669 temple-order/Jat environment
   -> 1672 Satnami rising near Narnaul
   -> 1675 Guru Tegh Bahadur executed at Delhi (Nov.)
   -> 1678 Jaswant Singh dies at Jamrud
   -> 1679 jizyah reimposed + Rajput war sharpens
   -> Jan. 1681 Prince Akbar revolt
   -> 1698 Ajit Singh recognised (limited)
   -> 1699 Khalsa founded
   -> 1704 southern suspension of jizyah
   -> 1707 Aurangzeb dies / 1712 formal abolition

3) LAW AND SOVEREIGNTY
  sharia -> legal idiom / moral preference
  zawabit -> ruler-made regulation / political discretion
  Fatawa-i-Alamgiri -> Hanafi compendium, NOT constitution
  empire -> emperor appoints / taxes / wars / grants exceptions
  chain -> sharia opinion -> emperor frames order -> qazi or officer applies
           or evades -> locality absorbs, negotiates or resists

4) PERIODISE POLICY
  early pragmatic continuity
   -> court-symbolic puritan turn
      (end of jharoka darshan / reduced Nauroz / limits on court music /
       regulated coin formulae / muhtasibs appointed / mosque repair)
   -> c.1669-79 sharper legal-symbolic differentiation
   -> late wartime rule with exceptions and uneven enforcement
  RULE -> symbolic change matters; uneven enforcement does not erase it.

5) JIZYAH, 1679
  poll tax on differentiated non-Muslim subjecthood; not land revenue, not customs
  exempt categories -> women, children, indigent persons and some dependants
  receipts -> separate treasury for needy Muslims / ulama, NOT general-treasury relief
   + orthodoxy
   + public assertion of Islamic rulership
   + juristic / ulama patronage
   + fiscal form
   -> collector-subject friction, corruption, crop-failure remission
   -> large official total (Satish Chandra) != realised yield
   -> 1704 southern suspension -> 1712 abolition under Jahandar Shah
   -> symbolic cost > neat fiscal gain

6) TEMPLE POLICY METHOD
  evidence ladder
   1. general or provincial order
   2. site-specific destruction / conversion / defacement
   3. wartime punishment in rebellious zones
   4. grants, protection or non-interference elsewhere
   5. material remains and later complaint records
  method -> dated site -> source type -> stated context -> actual action
            -> regional reach -> counter-evidence
  named cases -> c.1669 order context; Kashi Vishvanath; Keshava Rai temple at
                 Mathura; 1679-80 Rajput-war demolitions in Jodhpur-Udaipur areas
  counter-evidence -> grants, protection and non-interference continue elsewhere
  RULE -> reject both caricatures: neither universal destruction nor blanket
          exoneration fits the dated site-by-site evidence.

7) DIFFERENTIATED INCORPORATION
  continued Hindu, Rajput and some Maratha mansabdars in imperial service
   + administrative need
   + rank-jagir incentives
  houses still in service after 1679 -> Amber, Bikaner, Bundi, Kota
   - sharper public hierarchy
   - discriminatory orders issued, modified or locally evaded
   = composite service survives, equality does not
  RULE -> continued service != equality; discrimination != total exclusion.

8) NORTH INDIAN UNREST
  Jats -> Mathura-Agra / cultivators, zamindars and clan communities
       -> revenue pressure, local power, official coercion, religious-political climate
       -> c.1669 rising under Gokula
       -> later resistance under Rajaram and Churaman = recurrence, not one event
  Satnamis -> Narnaul 1672 / local clash -> cultivator-artisan mobilisation -> suppression
  Bundelas -> Champat Rai and later Chhatrasal / chiefship, extraction, service, rebellion
  RULE -> each movement has its own locality, social base and chronology;
          do not project the later Bharatpur state backward on to Gokula.

9) GURU TEGH BAHADUR
  gurushipp 1664 -> eastern travels -> return to Punjab -> arrest
   -> execution at Delhi, November 1675
  Persian security / rebellion framing
    <-> Sikh martyr memory and defence of religious freedom
    <-> later Kashmir-Pandit tradition: genre and chronology caution
  Satish Chandra -> the punishment was unjustified
  1699 Khalsa under Guru Gobind Singh -> major later consequence
  verdict -> profound antecedent and deep legitimacy cost,
             not a single automatic switch for every later Sikh development.

10) RAJPUT ALLIANCE BEFORE BREACH
  watan authority + mansab/jagir + honour and precedence
   + succession recognition + military service
  early Aurangzeb still relies on Jai Singh (1665 settlement with Shivaji)
   and on Jaswant Singh in major service
  RULE -> an unequal bargain stayed stable only while Mughal guarantees
          remained credible.

11) MARWAR CRISIS, 1678-79
  Jaswant Singh dies at Jamrud, 1678
   -> posthumous claimant Ajit Singh
   -> Marwar taken into khalisa amid disputed succession, debt, withheld revenue
      and disorder (khalisa precedent exists)
   -> official overreach, search and conduct, custody of Ajit, honour politics
   -> Inder Singh receives the tika -> Rathor sardars reject the settlement
   -> competing claims of the ranis and Rathor sardars mishandled
   -> Durgadas Rathore organises resistance and protects Ajit's claim
   -> Rathors restore Ajit's tika at Jodhpur -> rival investiture, not imperial grant
   -> succession + watan + debt + mistrust converge
  evidence -> Waqa-i-Ajmer and the Jodhpur Hukumat-ri-Bahi
  RULE -> khalisa != automatic annexation; the credibility of Mughal guarantees
          is the real issue.

12) MEWAR AND PRINCE AKBAR
  Rana Raj Singh opposes occupation of Marwar and interference in succession
   -> Mewar supports the Rathors -> Aravalli terrain raises imperial cost
   -> Prince Akbar revolts January 1681 with Rathor support
   -> Aurangzeb splits the coalition by letters, intelligence and manoeuvre;
      Akbar flees towards the Deccan
   -> revolt fails militarily; prestige and trust damage remains
   -> Mewar settles after Raj Singh's death; Rathor war continues intermittently
   -> 1698 recognition of Ajit Singh is limited, not full restoration

13) HISTORIOGRAPHY AND VERDICT
  communal monocause -> sees real discrimination, over-explains by identity
  statecraft-only revision -> sees succession/debt/strategy, understates coercion
  balanced view (Satish Chandra) -> orthodoxy + politics + locality + uneven reach
  Chandra -> victim of circumstances AND maker of those circumstances

Chandra on Rajput policy -> blundering, yielding no real advantage
source ladder
- court chronicles -> official idiom and chronology, but selective
- farmans and grants -> local action, not empire-wide uniformity
- local Rajput records -> Waqa-i-Ajmer, Hukumat-ri-Bahi
- Sikh tradition -> memory and identity, genre caution
- material remains -> survival, damage, repair; never motive by itself
verdict -> differentiated incorporation survives institutionally, yet sharper
hierarchy and mishandled Rajput succession widen the gap between
coercive reach and political legitimacy.

PRELIMS TRAPS
jizyah != land revenue, customs duty or a tax on every Hindu
jizyah receipts != relief of the general treasury
Fatawa-i-Alamgiri != constitution or uniform criminal code
khalisa != automatic or final annexation
continued Hindu service != equality
old/new temple distinction mattered formally but did not settle every case
one grant or one demolition never proves the whole empire
1698 recognition != restoration of the pre-1678 compact
Topic 23 owns the Deccan-Maratha war

MAINS ANSWER SPINE
intro -> differentiated rule under pressure, dated and localised
body 1 -> sharia / zawabit and periodisation
body 2 -> jizyah and the temple evidence ladder
body 3 -> North Indian unrest and the Sikh legitimacy cost
body 4 -> Marwar-Mewar rupture and prestige loss
conclusion -> contributory to weakened legitimacy and alliance trust,
not the sole cause of imperial decline